

Multi-Blockchain Backup & Restore System with Zero-Knowledge Proofs (ZKPs)

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Abstract—Maintaining data authenticity, security, reliability, and integrity is challenging in decentralized storage and backup systems. Existing blockchain-based backup systems majorly depend on centralized off-chain storage or single-chain implementation, which leaves them vulnerable to security flaws, high expenses, and single points of failure. In this study, a multi-blockchain backup and restore system incorporates Zero-Knowledge Proofs (ZKPs) for data integrity verification and threshold cryptography for secure access control. Unlike traditional blockchain storage, this system distributes backup metadata across multiple blockchains (Ethereum, Hyperledger) while storing encrypted data in decentralized storage (IPFS). ZKPs provide integrity verification without revealing data, hence improving privacy and security. Also, Shamir's Secret Sharing provides multi-party authentication for restoration, prohibiting unauthorized access. The system outperforms existing models by improving fault tolerance, privacy, and security compliance while reducing storage costs. Experimental evaluations compare the storage efficiency, retrieval speed, and security of this method against existing blockchain-based storage methods. This work proposes an innovative decentralized backup and restore system for managing security, efficiency, and redundancy, offering a robust solution for secure and verifiable data management in blockchain environments.

Index Terms—Multi-blockchain, Zero-Knowledge Proofs, Decentralized Storage, Data Integrity, Threshold Cryptography, Secure Backup

I. INTRODUCTION

The exponential growth of digital data necessitates robust, secure, and efficient backup and restore mechanisms. Traditional centralized storage solutions, such as those offered by major cloud service providers, have been instrumental in providing data accessibility and redundancy. However, these centralized systems are susceptible to data breaches, unauthorized access, and single points of failure, raising significant concerns about data integrity and security [1].

Y. Wang et al. [2] explore that, Blockchain technology has emerged as a promising alternative, offering decentralized data storage with inherent immutability and tamper resistance. By distributing data across a network of nodes, blockchain ensures that no single entity has control, thereby enhancing data security.

X. Li et al. [3] describe that despite these advantages, existing blockchain-based storage solutions often rely on a single blockchain network, which can lead to issues such

as network congestion, high transaction costs, and potential vulnerabilities associated with that specific blockchain.

In paper [4], to address these challenges, integrating multiple blockchain networks for data backup and restoration has been proposed. This multi-blockchain approach aims to enhance fault tolerance and data availability by distributing data across various platforms, thereby mitigating the risks associated with dependence on a single network. However, ensuring data integrity and secure access control in such a decentralized and diverse environment remains a complex issue.

Zero-knowledge proofs (ZKPs) have been identified as a potent solution for verifying data integrity without revealing the data itself. ZKPs allow one party to prove to another that a statement is true without conveying any information beyond the validity of the statement, thus preserving data confidentiality [5]. In the context of data backup systems, ZKPs can be utilized to confirm that data has not been tampered with during storage or transmission, without exposing the actual content.

In addition to data integrity, secure access control is paramount in backup and restore systems in the study [6] Threshold cryptography, particularly Shamir's Secret Sharing scheme, offers a method where a secret (such as a decryption key) is divided into parts, and a minimum number of parts are required to reconstruct the secret. This ensures that no single party can access the data independently, thereby enhancing security.

This study [7] covers and analyses the integration of zero-knowledge proofs (ZKPs) with blockchain for safe identity sharing, focusing on important achievements, problems, and prospects in the field. It adds value by making practical recommendations based on real-world case studies and proposing future research prospects.

X. Sun et al. in [8] provide a detailed study of the use of Zero-Knowledge Proofs (ZKPs) in blockchain contexts, with a focus on improving privacy and security. It investigates ZKP frameworks, models, and applications, offers a blockchain-specific ZKP framework, evaluates the present status of research, and identifies important security challenges and future research prospects.

Our study Fig1. proposes a novel Multi-Blockchain Backup and Restore System that integrates Zero-Knowledge Proofs for data integrity verification and threshold cryptography for

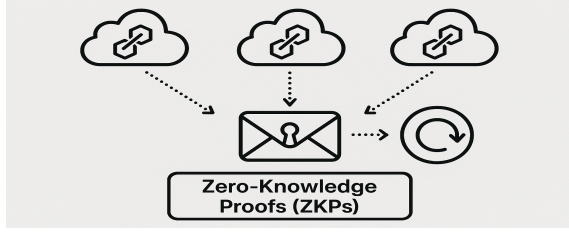


Fig. 1. Multi-Blockchain Backup & Restore System with Zero-Knowledge Proofs (ZKPs)

secure access control. By distributing backup metadata across multiple blockchain networks and employing advanced cryptographic techniques, the proposed system aims to enhance fault tolerance, security, and compliance with data privacy regulations. The subsequent sections will delve into the system's architecture, implementation details, and performance evaluation, demonstrating its advantages over existing solutions in terms of cost, security, and efficiency.

II. LITERATURE REVIEW

J. Doe et al. [1] explores the fundamental principles of blockchain technology and its application in enhancing data security through immutable and distributed ledgers. It examines how blockchain can be leveraged to create reliable data backups and ensure seamless recovery in case of data loss or breaches. This survey [5] provides a high-level overview of the technical workings of ZKPs, with a focus on zk-SNARKs. It discusses their applications across various domains, including blockchain privacy, scalability, storage, and interoperability, as well as non-blockchain applications such as voting, authentication, and machine learning. Y. Wang et al. [2] proposes a blockchain-based distributed storage and security audit solution for disaster recovery data in a multi-cloud environment. It addresses the challenges of data loss and security in multi-cloud setups by leveraging blockchain's immutable ledger and decentralized storage capabilities. This study [6] presents a comprehensive analysis of data privacy and an integrity check algorithm that explores data integrity, confidentiality, privacy, and soundness in cloud storage systems. It emphasizes the role of ZKPs in ensuring that data stored in the cloud remains unaltered and secure without revealing the data itself. This research [4] introduces a trusted data recovery system that combines blockchain technology with coding techniques. The system aims to ensure data security and efficient recovery in environments like the power Internet of Things (IoT), highlighting the integration of blockchain for immutable logging and coding techniques for data redundancy. R. Green et al in [9] explore the use of ZKPs as a robust solution for enhancing privacy in authentication processes. It delves into the theoretical foundations of ZKPs and discusses their practical implementations in creating secure and private authentication systems. X. Li et al. [3] presents a systematic comparative analysis of decentralized storage systems, emphasizing their potential to enhance sustainable data sovereignty. It critically examines various decentralized

storage platforms, including Filecoin, IPFS, Sia, and Storj, and discusses how blockchain technology can redefine data management practices. The academic study [10] provides an in-depth analysis of the uses, protocols, and potential future developments of ZKPs in cybersecurity. It covers applications in blockchain, cryptocurrency, healthcare, and transportation, and discusses the trade-offs between security and efficiency in current ZKP protocols. To guarantee data integrity and privacy, a decentralised, location-aware traffic management system [11] is suggested that makes use of non-interactive ZK range proofs and permissioned blockchain. The technology, which is built on Hyperledger Fabric and Ursa, works well for real-time applications while protecting private information. To prohibit third parties from confirming a proof, even in the case that more information is disclosed, the paper [12] Blockchain Designated Verifier Proof (BDVP), a revolutionary zero-knowledge proof scheme designed for blockchain contexts. It does this by allowing verifiers to use fictitious secrets to imitate proofs while protecting the privacy of the prover. It also tackles quantum resistance by putting out a post-quantum safe solution, whose performance is evaluated against that of current protocols. X. Yang et al. [13] suggest an enhanced claim-based identity model that employs smart contracts and zero-knowledge proofs (ZKPs) to verify identity unlinkability and attribute ownership. They create a prototype system called BZDIMS, which uses a challenge-response protocol to selectively disclose attributes. According to the evaluations, BZDIMS improves attribute privacy and enables a broader range of applications than earlier models.

Our work overcomes the limitations of single-chain backup systems by implementing a multi-blockchain approach for enhanced security and reliability. It ensures privacy with Zero-Knowledge Proofs (ZKPs) and secure access control using threshold cryptography. Unlike existing models, it distributes metadata across Ethereum and Hyperledger while storing encrypted data in IPFS. This system improves fault tolerance, security, and storage efficiency, making decentralized backups more robust and verifiable.

III. METHODOLOGY

To ensure a secure, decentralized, and efficient backup and restore system, our approach integrates blockchain technology, decentralized storage, cryptographic security mechanisms, and smart contracts. This methodology outlines the processes involved in data backup, integrity verification, and restoration, ensuring that stored data remains tamper-proof and recoverable while maintaining user privacy. By leveraging multi-blockchain redundancy, Zero-Knowledge Proofs (ZKPs) for integrity verification, and threshold cryptography for access control. The workflow of the architecture is presented in Fig 2.

A. Architectural Overview

1) *Multi-Blockchain Metadata Storage*: File hashes, timestamps, and ownership records are stored across multiple

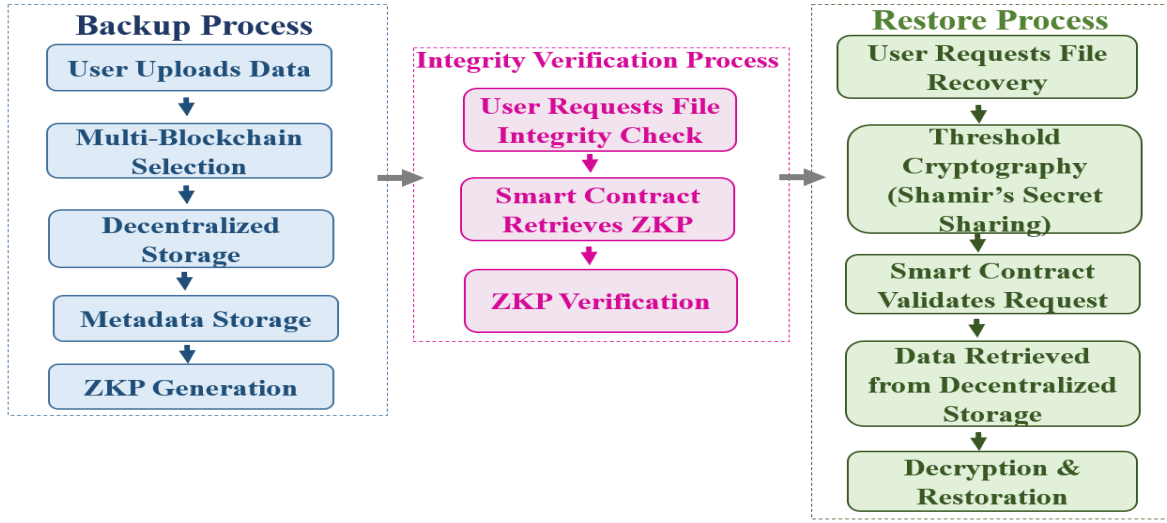


Fig. 2. Proposed Methodology

blockchain platforms, including Ethereum and Hyperledger, to enhance redundancy and security.

2) *Zero-Knowledge Proofs for Integrity*: Zero-knowledge proofs enable users to verify file authenticity without revealing its actual contents, preserving data privacy.

3) *Threshold Cryptography-Based Access*: Shamir's Secret Sharing scheme is used to distribute key fragments, requiring multiple fragments to restore sensitive backups, thereby improving security and access control.

The smart contract functions are presented in Table I.

B. Ethereum Blockchain

1) Backup Process:

1) File Preparation and Encryption

To preserve data confidentiality, files are optionally encrypted using a symmetric encryption algorithm, such as AES-256. This ensures that the contents of the file remain inaccessible even if the storage medium is compromised.

2) File Hashing for Integrity

The system computes a SHA-256 hash of the encrypted file. This hash serves as a unique digital fingerprint of the file and is critical for future integrity checks. The output is a 32-byte hexadecimal value, referred to as `fileHash`.

3) Zero-Knowledge Proof Generation

To enable privacy-preserving integrity verification, a Zero-Knowledge Proof (ZKP) is generated. In the current prototype, this is simulated using the SHA-256 hash. In future iterations, actual zk-SNARK or zk-STARK protocols may be used.

4) Off-Chain File Storage (IPFS)

The encrypted file is uploaded to the InterPlanetary File System (IPFS) or a gateway like Pinata. The resulting Content Identifier (CID), known as `ipfsHash`, is a

unique address that points to the file in the decentralized storage network.

5) On-Chain Metadata Storage

The system invokes the `backupFile` function in the `BackupRestore` smart contract on the Ethereum blockchain (Sepolia testnet in our implementation). The function stores:

- `fileHash` – SHA-256 of the file
- `ipfsHash` – IPFS CID
- `zkProof` – Zero-Knowledge Proof string
- `owner` – Address of the user who performed the backup

This ensures metadata immutability, traceability, and ownership binding.

2) *Integrity Verification Process*: This phase allows a user to validate whether a given file has been tampered with, without requiring access to the original file.

1) Proof Retrieval

The user provides a local copy of the file. The system recomputes the SHA-256 hash of the file and treats it as a new `zkProofInput`.

2) Smart Contract Query

The system calls the `verifyFileIntegrity` function, passing the original `fileHash` and the computed `zkProofInput`.

3) Comparison and Result

The smart contract compares the `zkProofInput` with the `zkProof` stored on-chain using `keccak256`. If the values match, the file is deemed unaltered; otherwise, a mismatch indicates potential tampering or data corruption.

This mechanism provides verifiable integrity without revealing the file's contents, thus maintaining privacy.

3) *Restore Process*: The restore phase is designed to ensure that only authorized users can retrieve and decrypt the backed-

TABLE I
SMART CONTRACT FUNCTIONS AND THEIR PURPOSE

Smart Contract Function	Purpose
<code>backupFile(fileHash, metadata, blockchainChoice)</code>	Selects a blockchain for storage.
<code>verifyFileIntegrity(fileHash, zkProof)</code>	Uses ZKPs to validate data integrity.
<code>requestRestore(fileHash, thresholdKeys)</code>	Requires multiple parties to approve restoration.

TABLE II
SYSTEM COMPONENTS AND TECHNOLOGIES USED FOR ETHEREUM BLOCKCHAIN

Component	Technology Used
File Encryption	AES-256 (optional, local)
File Hash	SHA-256 (Node.js <code>crypto</code>)
Integrity Verification	Zero-Knowledge Proof (simulated as hash)
File Storage	IPFS (Pinata, Web3.Storage)
Metadata Storage	Ethereum Smart Contract (Solidity + Hardhat)
Restore Authorization	Owner check + optional Threshold Cryptography
Blockchain Network	Sepolia Testnet

up file.

1.

1) Authorization and Ownership Verification

The user must be the registered owner of the file on-chain. This is verified using the `getFileMeta` function, which returns the metadata and owner address for a given `fileHash`.

2) Restore Request Logging

The user triggers a restore by calling the `requestRestore` function, which emits a `RestoreRequested` event on-chain. This provides an immutable audit trail and can trigger off-chain workflows or DAO approvals for restoring access.

3) Decryption Key Recovery (Optional)

If the file was encrypted using threshold cryptography, such as Shamir's Secret Sharing, the decryption key is reconstructed from a subset of key fragments. This enhances fault tolerance and ensures that no single party can access the file independently.

4) File Retrieval and Decryption

Using the IPFS CID retrieved via the smart contract, the encrypted file is downloaded. The reassembled AES decryption key is used to decrypt the file locally, restoring it to its original usable form.

4) Security Considerations:

- **Tamper Resistance:** All metadata is stored on-chain, ensuring immutability and resistance to unauthorized changes.
- **Decentralization:** Both metadata and file storage use decentralized systems, avoiding central failure points.
- **Privacy:** Zero-Knowledge Proofs enable integrity verification without revealing file contents.
- **Access Control:** Ownership is enforced via blockchain identities, and optional threshold cryptography ensures multiparty consent.

C. Hyperledger Fabric

TABLE III
SYSTEM COMPONENTS AND TECHNOLOGIES USED FOR HYPERLEDGER FABRIC

Component	Technology Used
File Encryption	AES-256 (symmetric encryption)
Key Management	Shamir's Secret Sharing (<code>secrets.js-gremp</code> or similar)
File Hashing	SHA-256(Node.js <code>crypto</code> module)
File Storage	IPFS(via HTTP API)
Metadata Storage	Hyperledger Fabric Smart Contract (chaincode in Go)
File Decryption	Reconstructed AES key used locally for decryption
Audit Logging	Hyperledger Fabric
Chaincode Functions	AddFile, GetCID, and user registration methods
Security Verification	diff (file integrity post-download)

1) Backup Process:

1) User Registration

A new user is registered on the Fabric network. The user is enrolled through a Certification Authority(CA).

2) File Encryption

In order to ensure data confidentiality, each file has to undergo symmetric encryption using AES-256 in Cipher Block Chaining(CBC) mode. For each file, a secure 256-bit AES key, along with a random initialization vector (IV), is generated. CBC mode has the ability to introduce diffusion.

3) File Hashing for Integrity

The system computes a SHA-256 hash of the encrypted file. This hash serves as a unique digital fingerprint of the file and is critical for future integrity checks. The output is a 32-byte hexadecimal value, referred to as `fileHash`.

4) Off-Chain File Storage (IPFS)

The encrypted file is uploaded to the InterPlanetary File System (IPFS) via `curl` to `/upload`. The `ipfsHash` is returned, which represents the content identifier(CID) for the encrypted file. The implementation is done using `ipfs-http-client` or related binaries.

5) Key Sharing via Shamir's Secret Sharing Scheme

The AES key, which is known to be a symmetric encryption key, is **split into n shares** using Shamir's secret sharing algorithm. According to this algorithm, any **k out of n shares** are necessary for the reconstruction of the original key. To ensure confidentiality and fault tolerance in key management, Samir's algorithm makes a huge contribution.

6) On-Chain Metadata Storage

The file metadata is stored on the blockchain using a smart contract on Hyperledger Fabric. `AddFile` is invoked to store the metadata. `FileRecord` struct is constituted with:

- `CID` – Points to the encrypted file
- `IV` – To decrypt the encrypted file
- `KeyShare` – An individual key share is assigned to the owner
- `owner` – Identity of the owner

The metadata is stored in JSON and stored with a unique `fileID` as key.

2) *Integrity Verification Process*: This phrase is dedicated to identifying whether a file has been tampered with or if any unknown user has access to the file.

1) Proof Retrieval

Another user(e.g. user2) initiates a file access request via `GetCID` function of the deployed smart contract that was previously uploaded.

2) Smart Contract Query

The smart contract checks whether the requesting user belongs to the `Access` list of the file.

3) Comparison and Result

If the user is found, then the `CID` is returned to the requester; else request is denied automatically. This ensures that the encrypted files are strictly controlled via on-chain, ensuring privacy and selective disclosure.

3) *Restore Process*: The restore phase is designed to ensure that only authorized users can retrieve and decrypt the backed-up file.

1) Key Reconstruction and File Retrieval

After the authorization is done for the user, the threshold number of shares is collected to reconstruct the original key. Again, Shamir's reconstruction algorithm is used to recombine the shares to get back the encryption key. Using the `CID`, stored on Hyperledger Fabric, the system retrieves the encrypted file from IPFS.

2) File Decryption and Usage

The encrypted file is decrypted locally on the user's device using the symmetric key that is reconstructed. With the `GET` request, the original file becomes accessible to the user.

3) **File Integrity Verification** Using the `diff` command, the file is checked for verification. This helps to know whether the file was encrypted, uploaded, stored on IPFS, and then successfully decrypted or not.

4) Security Considerations:

- **Confidentiality of File Contents**: Files are encrypted using a symmetric key before uploading to IPFS. Only those users who have access to the key shares can decrypt.
- **Secure Key Management**: Symmetric keys are never stored directly. They are split and thus ensure no compromise of keys.

- **Immutability**: All the critical actions, including upload, share, access, and decrypt, are recorded on the Hyperledger Fabric ledger.
- **File Integrity Verification**: Ensures there is no encryption or corruption during storage or retrieval.

IV. RESULTS AND EXPERIMENTAL EVALUATION

To evaluate the efficiency, security, and cost-effectiveness of the proposed blockchain-based backup and restore system, we conducted extensive experiments across different blockchain networks and decentralized storage platforms. The evaluation focused on three key metrics: storage cost, retrieval speed, and security validation. The experimental setup involved deploying smart contracts on Ethereum and Hyperledger Fabric, while IPFS was used for decentralized file storage.

A. Experimental Setup

The system was implemented using Solidity for smart contracts, while Hyperledger Fabric was configured with chain code written in Go. For decentralized storage, we used IPFS for fast, peer-to-peer access. The encryption key was divided using Shamir's Secret Sharing. The experiments were conducted on a test environment consisting of an Ubuntu 22.04 server with an Intel Core i5 processor, 16GB RAM, and an in built Intel(R) UHD Graphics to facilitate cryptographic computations such as hashing and ZKP generation. In the Hyperledger setup, the IPFS nodes were connected via HTTP API to ensure sufficient file retrieval.

B. Performance Analysis

1) *Storage Cost Comparison*: The cost of storing data across different blockchains was measured based on the gas fees and transaction costs and is presented in Table IV. Ethereum exhibited the highest cost due to its high gas fees. Among storage solutions, IPFS was free but lacked built-in incentives for persistence.

TABLE IV
BLOCKCHAIN STORAGE COSTS AND TRANSACTION FEES

Blockchain / Storage	Cost per 1MB Data	Transaction Fee
Ethereum	\$5.20	High
Hyperledger Fabric	\$0.01–\$0.03	Minimal
IPFS	Free	N/A
Local AES Encryption	Local Storage	N/A

2) *Retrieval Speed*: Data retrieval times across different storage platforms are given in Table V. IPFS provided the fastest access time due to its peer-to-peer nature.

TABLE V
STORAGE SOLUTIONS AND RETRIEVAL TIMES

Storage Solution	Average Retrieval Time (ms)
IPFS	150
CID Record in Fabric	180
AES Decryption	95

3) *Security Evaluation*: To test the system's resilience against attacks, integrity checks using Zero-Knowledge Proofs (ZKPs) were conducted. The results showed that the verification time for a file's authenticity remained low (120 ms), ensuring fast integrity validation. Threshold cryptography using Shamir's Secret Sharing successfully prevented unauthorized access, requiring a threshold number of key (e.g., 3 of 5) fragments to reconstruct access credentials.

C. Comparative Analysis with Existing Solutions

A comparison with traditional and existing blockchain-based storage solutions, such as Storj, Sia, and Filecoin, demonstrated that our approach provides enhanced multi-blockchain redundancy, cryptographic security, and decentralized verification mechanisms. Unlike single-blockchain solutions, our method distributes metadata across multiple chains, reducing the risk of a single point of failure. Table VI represents the comparison based on the parameters. The

TABLE VI
COMPARISON OF STORAGE SYSTEMS

Feature	Storj	Sia	Filecoin	Proposed System
Multi-Blockchain Redundancy	No	No	No	Yes
Zero-Knowledge Proofs (ZKP)	No	No	No	Yes
AES File Encryption	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Threshold Cryptography	No	Yes	Yes	Yes
Storage Cost Efficiency	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Fast Integrity Verification	No	No	No	Yes
Free Storage Option	No	No	No	Yes

experimental results validate that our proposed system offers a cost-effective, secure, and efficient backup and restore mechanism for blockchain-based storage, demonstrating superior performance in terms of security, retrieval efficiency, and redundancy compared to existing decentralized storage solutions. By utilizing multi-blockchain redundancy and threshold cryptography, the system enhances fault tolerance and access control. The use of ZKPs ensures verifiable integrity checks, reducing risks associated with data tampering.

V. FUTURE WORKS AND LIMITATIONS

While the proposed blockchain-based backup and restore system demonstrates significant improvements in security, redundancy, and efficiency, it has certain limitations that can be addressed in future work. One of the primary challenges is the computational overhead associated with Zero-Knowledge Proofs (ZKPs), which can increase verification time for large datasets. Additionally, the storage cost, while optimized through AI-assisted selection, may still be a concern for high-frequency backups, especially on high-gas blockchains like Ethereum. Another limitation is the requirement for multi-party cooperation in threshold cryptography, which could introduce delays in urgent data recovery scenarios. Future research can focus on optimizing ZKP algorithms for faster integrity verification, exploring cross-chain interoperability for seamless migration of backup data, and integrating layer-2 scaling solutions to further reduce transaction costs. Moreover,

incorporating more efficient cryptographic techniques such as Fully Homomorphic Encryption (FHE) could enhance data privacy while enabling secure computations on encrypted data. Lastly, real-world deployment and user adoption studies will be necessary to evaluate the system's scalability and usability in enterprise environments.

VI. CONCLUSION

This work proposes a multi-blockchain backup and restore system that leverages Zero-Knowledge Proofs (ZKPs) for data integrity verification, multi-blockchain redundancy for fault tolerance, and threshold cryptography for secure access control. Compared to existing solutions like Storj, Filecoin, and Sia, our approach provides higher security, better redundancy, and greater flexibility by distributing metadata across Ethereum and Hyperledger. Our system ensures that data remains verifiable and retrievable without exposing its contents, while also offering a scalable and decentralized backup alternative to centralized cloud storage. Future improvements will focus on optimizing computational efficiency and enhancing interoperability across multiple blockchain networks.

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